

DECISION

The cost of postponing is almost always higher than the cost of getting it wrong.

How to decide fast without complete information.

AND THE CONSEQUENCE

Whoever waits for perfect data pays for the closed window.

THE CASCADE

Waiting disguises itself as prudence.

WHAT YOU SEE

A piece of data is missing, and you ask for one more week of research.

THE MECHANISM

The data arrives, and it would not have changed the choice at all.

THE CONSEQUENCE

The window closed, and now the decision is about the damage.

Postponing is also deciding. Only without owning the authorship.

THE FORK

What does that missing data actually do?

WHAT THE DATA DOES

01

Does it change the choice?

wait, and put a deadline on the waiting

02

Does it only change the size of the bet?

decide smaller, and move

03

Does it change nothing?

then you already have enough

Data that does not change the choice is comfort, not information.

THE METHOD

The Four Locks.

01 **CUTOFF**

which information, if missing, changes the choice

02 **RISK**

the worst that happens if you are wrong

03 **SIGNAL**

what you will watch to know you were wrong,
and when

04 **WAY BACK**

the date set to revisit it, and what happens
then

A decision locked on all four is reversible. Without them, it is a gamble dressed as a plan.

WHAT TO ASK, IN ORDER

Four questions, four locks.

01 • CUTOFF

What information would change your choice?

only that one is worth waiting for

02 • RISK

If you are wrong, what do we lose?

money, time or reputation, pick the name

03 • SIGNAL

What will tell you it went wrong?

and how long it takes to show

04 • WAY BACK

When do we come back to this decision?

a date on the calendar, not an intention

TWO MODELS

Two ways to decide with little data.

THE COMMON MODEL

A gamble

Decides and moves on

Finds the error at month end close

Has no review date

When it fails, hunts for a culprit

THE DESIGNED MODEL

A locked decision

Decides and names the risk out loud

Defines the signal that flags it early

Sets the return before leaving the room

When it fails, revisits the criterion

MISTAKE AND CONSEQUENCE

Three habits that become sluggishness.

01 Asking for more data without saying which.

- a generic request is postponement wearing the look of rigor.

02 Chasing the right decision instead of the correctable one.

- certainty is expensive and almost always arrives late.

03 Deciding without setting the return.

- with no review, the error only shows once it has cost a lot.

The first two delay. The third turns a small error into a large loss.

THE CHAIN

The thirty day test.

01

Ask what changes if you decide thirty days from now.



02

If the answer is nothing, the wait is fear with a calendar entry.



03

If the answer has a name and a number, the wait is legitimate.



WHERE LEADERSHIP STEPS IN

Legitimate waiting has a deadline and an owner. The rest is organized procrastination.

RUN IT THIS WAY NEXT TIME

Three moves on the next decision.



STEP 01

Write down the data that would change the choice.

if you cannot name it, you can already decide



STEP 02

Name the worst case in one sentence.

and say whether the company survives it



STEP 03

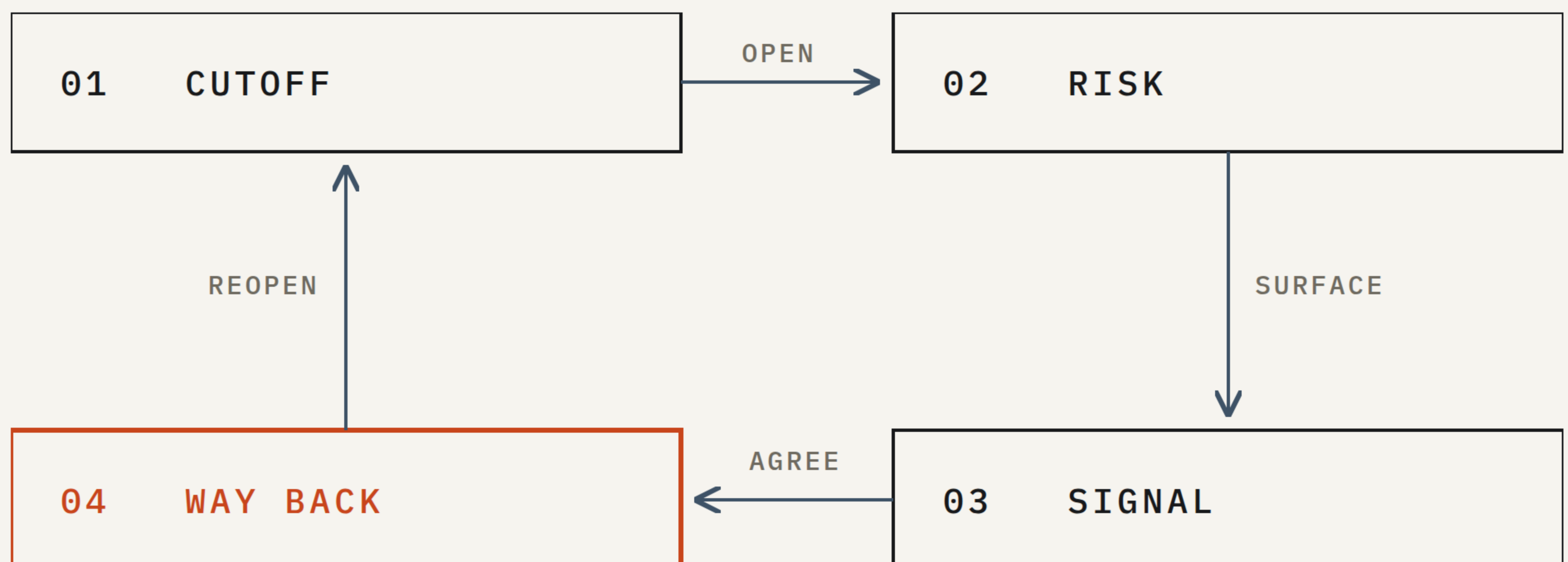
Set the return date before you leave.

on the calendar, with the people who will review it

The most forgotten lock is the way back. It is also the cheapest to install.

THE MODEL THAT STICKS

The Four Locks, a loop and not a list.



A fast decision is not a hunch. It is an error that is cheap and visible early.

SAVE THIS FOR LATER

on the next decision stalled waiting for data.

FABIO GARCIA

MANAGEMENT AS ENGINEERING
/IN/FALERCIA